

1486

TEMPLE OF TENOCHTITLAN

In 1486, the Mexica (Aztec) *tlatoni* (king) Tizoc died and was succeeded by his brother Ahuizotl. In the following year, 1487, Ahuizotl reopened the great temple in Tenochtitlan, capital of the Mexican Aztec Empire, marking the event

with a mass ritual sacrifice in which the victim's hearts were offered to the Aztec gods.



◁ Aztec sacrificial stone, c. 1481-86

1492 CHRISTOPHER COLUMBUS CROSSES THE ATLANTIC

Genoese sailor Christopher Columbus won the backing of the Spanish monarchy for a plan to sail westward to Asia. On board the carrack *Santa Maria*, with two other ships, he reached the Bahamas after almost six weeks at sea. Making three other transatlantic voyages to 1504, Columbus was slow to realize he had found a continent unknown to Europeans.

His voyages established a permanent link between the Americas and Eurasia.

▷ *Landing of Columbus*, John Vanderlyn, 1842-47



1480



1485

TUDOR DYNASTY FOUNDED

In the final stage of the York-Lancaster Wars of the Roses, Henry Tudor, a Lancastrian, invaded England to challenge the rule of Yorkist King Richard III. Exploiting discontent with Richard – who was suspected of murdering his predecessor, child-king Edward V – Henry attracted wide support. Richard was defeated and killed at Bosworth Field. Ruling as Henry VII, the new king married Elizabeth of York to consolidate his new Tudor dynasty.

◁ Henry VII's first act of parliament

1488 Portuguese sailor
Bartolomeu Dias rounds the
Cape of Good Hope and enters
the Indian Ocean